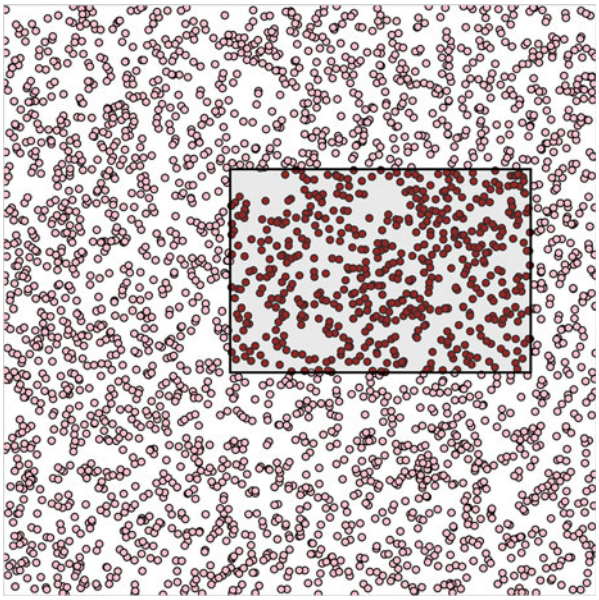


Figure 11.12 Highlighting points in a selected region

Another way to explain a quadtree is to show it. That's what this information visualization stuff is for, right? Figure 11.13 shows the quadrants that a quadtree produces based on a set of point data.

Creating a quadtree with xy data of the kind we have in our dataset is easy, as you can see in listing 11.15. We set the x and y accessors like we do with layouts and other D3 functions.

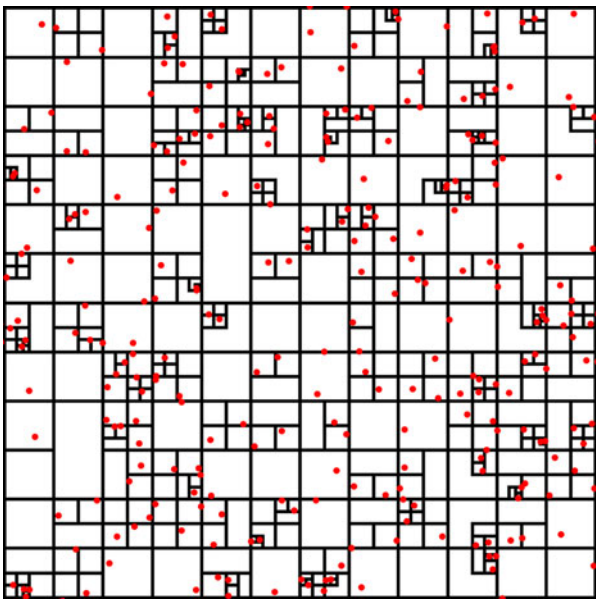


Figure 11.13 A quadtree for points shown in red with quadrant regions stroked in black. Notice how clusters of points correspond to subdivision of regions of the quadtree. Every point falls in only one region, but each region is nested in several levels of parent regions.